

CHERIE FRANCIS

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SUMMARY

Product Designer with a background in Product Management, Mechanical Engineering and UX & Interaction Design. Experienced in taking digital products from research and concept through prototyping, usability testing and iteration, with a strong understanding of product development and technical feasibility.

EXPERIENCE

Product Manager

Feb 2024 – Aug 2025

Integral LED (a division of Integral Memory Plc.) | London, UK

Led the development and launch of LED lighting products across research, specification, supplier management and cross-functional delivery.

- Owned 2 product ranges from concept to launch, conducting market research and customer visits, defining specifications, negotiating pricing, placing POs and presenting to senior stakeholders.
- Introduced a battery-operated worklight range targeting a wider consumer audience, which secured a £1M retail deal expanding distribution to 450 UK stores.
- Delivered 30+ product ranges (~600 SKUs), coordinating suppliers, sample testing, product specifications, packaging and launch activities.
- Identified key product features and prepared specifications, instructions and content for website, packaging and marketing materials.
- Achieved cost savings of up to 40% through supplier negotiations, volume purchasing and packaging optimisation.
- Coordinated with international suppliers and internal Design, Marketing and Compliance teams, achieving a 95% on-time project completion rate.

Design Consultant

Aug 2023 – Jan 2024

Skyview Estate | St. Elizabeth, JA / Remote

Supported design activities for a residential housing development.

- Designed recreational areas including a pool house and architectural details to suit the development's layout and design theme.
- Sketched initial design concepts for housing features in Procreate for handoff to architects for technical drawings.
- Advised on the visual design of a billboard campaign, coordinating with designers and printers for execution.

Development Programme Manager Intern

Jun 2022 – Aug 2022

Mattel Inc. | El Segundo, CA, USA

Supported product development and process improvement initiatives within the Hot Wheels team.

- Led a team of engineers to develop a robotic arm prototype to automate chassis insertion during Hot Wheels assembly, exploring opportunities to reduce labour costs and enable more complex vehicle designs.
- Automated date-stamping and visual status indicators in a company-wide issue-tracking spreadsheet, improving visibility of outstanding issues.
- Streamlined packaging and product-design approvals in Adobe Workfront, centralising feedback and reducing unnecessary email traffic.

Research Assistant

Jun 2021 – Aug 2021

Stanford SHAPE Lab (Haptics Research Lab) | Stanford, CA, USA

Independent research project exploring haptic force-feedback interfaces, recognised by faculty for its potential in accessible and educational haptic technology.

- Designed and prototyped a haptic steering interface using Fusion 360, 3D printing and laser cutting.
- Programmed Arduino controls to rotate the wheel to a user-defined angle and trigger vibration feedback on arrival.

DESIGN PROJECTS

Nailed It! Mobile App - MSc Dissertation

May 2026 – Aug 2026

Portfolio: cheriefrancis.github.io/design/nailedit.html

- Designed and built a responsive computer-vision web app from concept to working prototype, addressing decision uncertainty in nail design selection.
- Led the end-to-end design process, including user research, user journeys, information architecture, wireframing, visual design, prototyping, usability testing and iterative refinement.
- Translated designs into a functional product using React, JavaScript, HTML, CSS, Flask, Roboflow and Firebase, working within technical constraints and iterating based on testing.
- Applied research into decision paralysis and Hick's Law to reduce choice overload and improve navigation through the design library.

EDUCATION

MSc in Design and Digital Media

Sep 2025 – Aug 2026

The University of Edinburgh - Concentration: UX & Interaction Design

- Coursework: UX Design, Design for Interactive Media, Game Design, Digital Playgrounds.
- Tools: Figma, Adobe Creative Suite, Unity.

BS in Mechanical Engineering

Sep 2019 – Jun 2023

Stanford University - Concentration: Product Realisation (Design & Manufacturing)

- Coursework: DFM, Additive Manufacturing, Biomechanics, Dynamics, Soft Robotics.
- Tools: 3D CAD, CAM, CNC Milling, Sandcasting, 3D Printing, Laser Cutting.

Secondary Education

Sep 2012 – Jun 2019

Hampton School

- 9 CSEC and 8 CAPE subjects (GCSE / A-Level equivalent), achieving Grade I (equivalent to A/A*) in all.
- Ranked 3rd in Jamaica for CAPE Chemistry Unit II.

SKILLS

UX & Research:	User Research, Usability Testing, User Journey Mapping, Information Architecture, Wireframing, Prototyping, A/B Testing, Competitor Analysis, Data Analysis
Design:	Figma, Adobe Creative Suite, Autodesk Fusion 360 (3D CAD), SketchUp, Unity, Procreate, Canva
Technical:	HTML, CSS, JavaScript, C#
Product & Delivery:	Product Management, Product Development, Project Management, Agile Methodologies, Stakeholder Management, Wrike
AI & Productivity:	Claude, ChatGPT, AI-Assisted Research & Documentation, Prompt Engineering
Manufacturing:	Design for Manufacture (DFM), 3D Printing, CAM, CNC Milling, Turning (Lathe), Laser Cutting, Sandcasting
Tools:	Miro, Power BI, Microsoft 365, Google Workspace
Languages:	English (Fluent), Spanish (Intermediate)

HOBBIES & INTERESTS

Travel • Video games • Nail design • Language learning